

Usage guide for the Ubuntu 10.10 Live DVD

This edition of *LFY* comes packed with a Live DVD of Ubuntu 10.10—a secure, fast and user friendly operating system that can power desktops, servers, netbooks and laptops.

This DVD is not the official DVD downloaded from the Ubuntu website. It contains Ubuntu 10.10 Live CD and ISO images for Kubuntu 10.10, Lubuntu 10.10, Ubuntu Netbook Edition 10.10 and Ubuntu Studio 10.10.

Using the *LFY* DVD, you can boot in to a Live Ubuntu system and explore the operating system without installing it. To boot from the *LFY* DVD, all you have to do is to set your BIOS to first boot from the DVD ROM drive and restart your computer with the *LFY* DVD inserted in the drive. This will make your computer boot in to Ubuntu 10.10 and give you the option to 'Try Ubuntu' or 'Install Ubuntu'. Click on the 'Try Ubuntu' option to try Ubuntu, directly from the DVD, without making any changes to your computer. You can even install the OS on your computer's hard disk by selecting 'Install Ubuntu'. The installation can be done later, too, by clicking the 'Install Ubuntu 10.10' icon on the Desktop after exploring the Live system. The installer is very intuitive and will guide you to completely install Ubuntu on your computer.

How to use the ISOs included on the *LFY* DVD

To try the OSs provided as ISO image, you will need to create a CD/DVD or USB drive. To create a CD/DVD, you have to use your existing OS and CD/DVD burning software that can burn an ISO image on a blank CD/DVD. When the CD/DVD is ready, simply put it in your CD/DVD drive, restart your computer and follow the instructions that appear on your screen.

To create an installable USB from the ISO, on Windows you will need a 2 GB pen drive and a universal USB installer (which can be downloaded from the Internet). Plug the pen drive in the computer and run the universal USB installer. Follow the instructions that appear on the screen and select the ISO file from the *LFY* DVD to create a bootable USB. Now, boot your computer using this USB and *Try/Install* Ubuntu. If your existing OS is Ubuntu and you want to make a bootable USB, then use the "Startup Disk Creator" utility.

is very innovative and neat, and saves screen real estate. It comes with a dock-style bar on the left with common applications, and a standard panel across the top. Click app icons in the dock to start them; a caret sign appears on the left side of icons whose applications are currently running, and there's a caret sign on the right side of the app icon which is currently active. You can drag-and-drop to rearrange icons, and can remove an icon by dragging it off the side-bar. To quit a program, right-click and select Quit from the menu.

If you click the Ubuntu button at the top left corner of the screen, you'll be presented with an iPad-like home screen, with high-resolution icons for your favourite destinations. Another great eye candy worth mentioning is the inclusion of the Workspaces option to switch between virtual desktops. You can access this feature by clicking on the purple Workspaces icon from the side-bar. Evolution also performs in a special mode that's more suited for the small screen sizes of netbooks. Beneath it are all the good enhancements of the

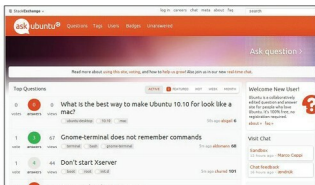


Figure 12: UNE home screen

stable Ubuntu 10.10 desktop edition. The global app menu is another nifty feature added in this release.

Experiencing Unity on your desktop

If the description above is interesting, or you're bored with the default GNOME, you can add Unity to your desktop without reinstalling. Add the Ubuntu netbook edition Personal Package Archive, open the terminal, and run `sudo add-apt-repository ppa:canonical-dx-team/une`. Your system will fetch the keys for the PPA (to verify that the downloaded packages are not compromised). Update your package list with `sudo apt-get update`. Fire up the Ubuntu Software Centre, go to Get software > Ubuntu netbook edition, search for Unity interface for UNE and hit Install. It will download the packages and install—Voilà! Unity is here. To start using it, log out and log in again.

Askubuntu

Askubuntu.com was launched as the first official Stack Exchange Q&A site for the Ubuntu community. Anyone can ask questions about Ubuntu's current and past releases, and get answers from the community. The site is well-built and easily searchable.

I took the plunge, and have been using the current release as my primary OS on my desktop and netbook for almost a week. I am very satisfied with the new improvements and eye candy; they really compete with the Mac OS X desktop appearance. For those who are still using past releases, don't wait any longer—take the plunge! Ubuntu 10.04 LTS users may want to hold off until Ubuntu 11.04, though. **END** 

References

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The author is a Linux enthusiast with over five years of experience in open source, networks and storage administration. Learning new technologies is his favourite hobby.